

Project Design Phase

Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	29 September 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-2362
Project Name	Streamlining IT procurement automating standard laptop with flow designer
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

The Problem-Solution Fit simply means that you have found a problem with your customer and that the solution you have realized for it actually solves the customer's problem. It helps entrepreneurs, marketers and corporate innovators identify behavioral patterns and recognize what would work and why.

Purpose:

- Solve complex problems in a way that fits the state of your customers.
- Succeed faster and increase your solution adoption by tapping into existing mediums and channels of behavior.
- Sharpen your communication and marketing strategy with the right triggers and messaging.
- Increase touch-points with your company by finding the right problem-behavior fit and building trust by solving frequent annoyances, or urgent or costly problems.
- Understand the existing situation in order to improve it for your target group.

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) (CS)

- Internal IT Helpdesk Operations: Helpdesk agents who are responsible for manually receiving, verifying, and fulfilling corporate asset requests.
- IT Infrastructure Managers: Decision-makers who manage local hardware inventory levels, budget approvals, and vendor contracts.
- Onboarding Employees & Existing Staff: End-users who need a functional, pre-configured standard laptop delivered without delay.

2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS (J&P;)

- Manual Procurement Friction: Requesters facing excessive delays due to manual multi-level manager approvals via emails.
- Inventory Untraceability: IT teams manually auditing physical spreadsheets to check stock availability, leading to ordering errors.
- Lack of Status Visibility: Employees having zero transparency on their laptop dispatch timeline, creating massive ticket backlogs.

3. TRIGGERS (TR)

- HR Automation Event: A new hire profile is activated in HR systems (e.g., Workday), pushing an automatic hardware request event.
- Device Lifecycle Policy: An employee's laptop passes its 3-year enterprise operational lifespan, auto-triggering a replacement request.
- Service Desk Backlogs: A high surge in recurring ticket volumes during bulk campus onboarding seasons.

4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER (EM)

- Before: Frustrated by delivery overheads, stressed about day-1 employee productivity, and anxious about delayed vendor responses.
- After: Relieved due to instant workflow execution, confident in automated asset logs, and satisfied with tracking dashboards.

5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS (AS)

- Manual Tracking Logs: Legacy email threads paired with shared Excel files. Pros: Low setup cost. Cons: Prone to data loss, no scalability.
- Basic Ticketing (Siloed Systems): Entering requests in standalone IT software. Pros: Centralizes basic inputs. Cons: Still demands manual vendor ordering and manual tracking.

6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS (CC)

- Governance Compliance: Rigid corporate protocols requiring explicit, recorded cost-center approvals before shipping assets.
- Licensing Tier Budgets: Cost boundaries associated with acquiring advanced ServiceNow Integration Hub Spoke licenses for third-party tools.
- Legacy Mindsets: Department heads who resist automated systems and favor physical or manual email approvals.

7. BEHAVIOUR (BE)

- IT Personnel Routine: Spending several hours chasing managers for sign-offs, manually validating stock, and double-keying information.
- Requester Routine: Submitting multiple follow-up incidents and messages to check hardware availability.

8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR (CH)

- 8.1 Online: ServiceNow Service Portal forms, corporate email loops, Slack/Microsoft Teams workspace nodes, and vendor order portals.
- 8.2 Offline: Physical storage checkouts, phone escalations to asset managers, and in-person device configuration setups.

9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE (RC)

- Disconnected Data Ecosystems: Total lack of integration between HR software, internal Asset Management (CMDB), and external vendor APIs.
- Absence of Rule-Based Orchestration: No centralized engine to evaluate request parameters automatically (e.g., branching based on live stock levels).

10. YOUR SOLUTION (SL)

- ServiceNow Flow Designer Automation: A comprehensive, automated workflow built in Flow Designer. It instantiates the second a standard laptop request drops, automatically validates available stock in the CMDB, routes dynamic approval cards via MS Teams, triggers outbound REST APIs to vendors if stock is depleted, and registers asset configurations flawlessly without manual intervention.